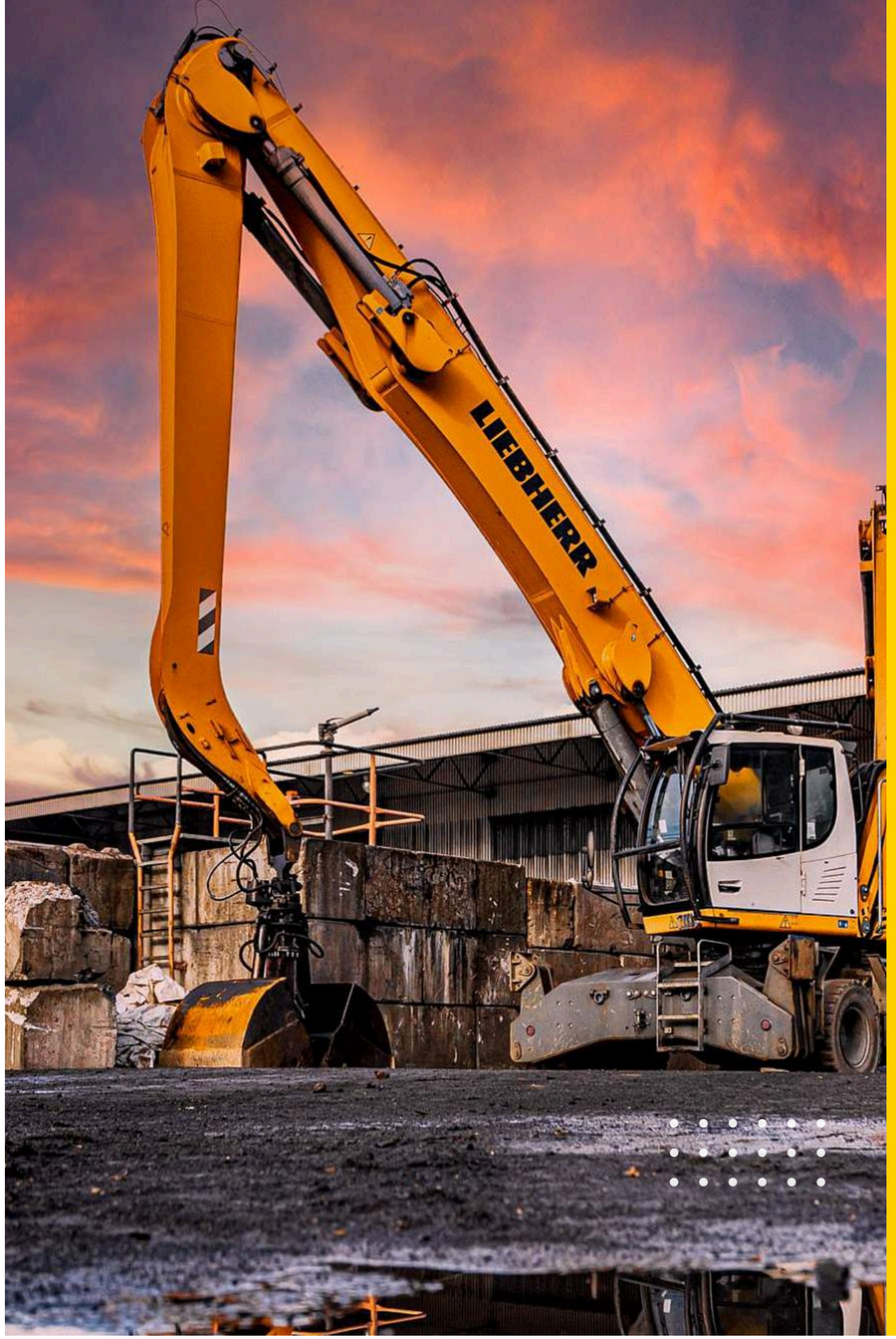


HAT1 FINANCIAL REPORTING · 2026

Liebherr Group

Financial Reporting and Investment Analysis 2022–2025

CENTRAL QUESTION

Should a long-term investor take a minority stake in Liebherr – and if not, why not yet?

Benchmark: Caterpillar Inc. and the average of 105 listed US machinery companies

PRESENTED BY

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Fontys University of Applied Sciences, Venlo · International Finance and Control · Lecturer: Kim Verspeek

THE ANSWER FIRST

Financially sound – but not yet an adequate return

Four findings decide the investment case

STRENGTH

53.5 %

Equity ratio 2025

Cash and current financial assets cover current debt **2.6 times**.

WEAKNESS

2.8 %

Operating margin 2025

Less than a fifth of Caterpillar (17.2 %) and the industry (15.9 %).

WEAKNESS

–€176 m

Free cash flow 2025

Negative in three of four years – investment runs ahead of cash generation.

ACCOUNTING

1.6–2.8 %

Margin range in our tests

The measurable accounting effects point to a **weaker**, not a stronger result.

Not yet. **Do not invest at present – reassess the case on the 2026 financial statements.**

Source: Report, Executive summary and chapters 7–8; Excel workbook, sheet Dashboard

COMPANY AND ENVIRONMENT

Diversification kept Liebherr growing while construction weakened

€14,772 m
Revenue 2025, +1.0 %

55,963
Employees

13
Product segments

1949
Family-owned · Bulle (CH)



Revenue 2025 by sector

63.3 % · Construction & mining · −5.5 %

36.7 % · Other · +14.7 %

€9,345 m vs. €5,427 m – components alone grew 35.5 %

External pressures

- **Demand:** European construction output forecast to grow only about 2 % a year until 2028
- **Prices and costs:** US tariffs and low-cost competitors – reported by Liebherr for its cranes
- **Financing:** ECB main refinancing rate 2.65 % (Sept. 2026) – machines cost customers more to finance

LIEBHERR'S OWN OUTLOOK

Orders at the start of 2026 above the previous year – further growth expected, but **no significant upswing before 2027**. US tariff policy remains a risk.

Source: Report, chapters 2 and 3 (§3.1.1) and §5.7; Liebherr-International AG (2026); EUROCONSTRUCT (2026); European Central Bank (2026)

How Liebherr creates competitive advantage

Differentiation in custom segments, scale in volume segments – financed by patient family capital



Diversified product portfolio

13 segments, from mining excavators to aerospace components, spread the market risk.

+14.7 %

other segments 2025, while construction & mining fell 5.5 %

THE PRICE

Stabilises revenue, but does not raise the margin.



Vertical integration

Key technologies built in-house; own sales and service companies instead of dealers.

29.1 %

PP&E in % of revenue (Caterpillar 22.4 %)

THE PRICE

Capital tied up in assets and stock – inventories 42.9 % of revenue.



Innovation & research

Research and development rose every year, fully expensed, financed from retained profit.

€708 m

R&D 2025 = 4.8 % of revenue (Caterpillar 3.2 %)

THE PRICE

Spending kept rising while operating profit fell 39 % in 2025.

WHAT IT MEANS

The advantage is real – but it sits in the asset base, not yet in the margin.

For the investor the question is not *whether* the advantage exists, but whether it is turned into returns.

Only €56 m of a €272 m profit was distributed in 2025.

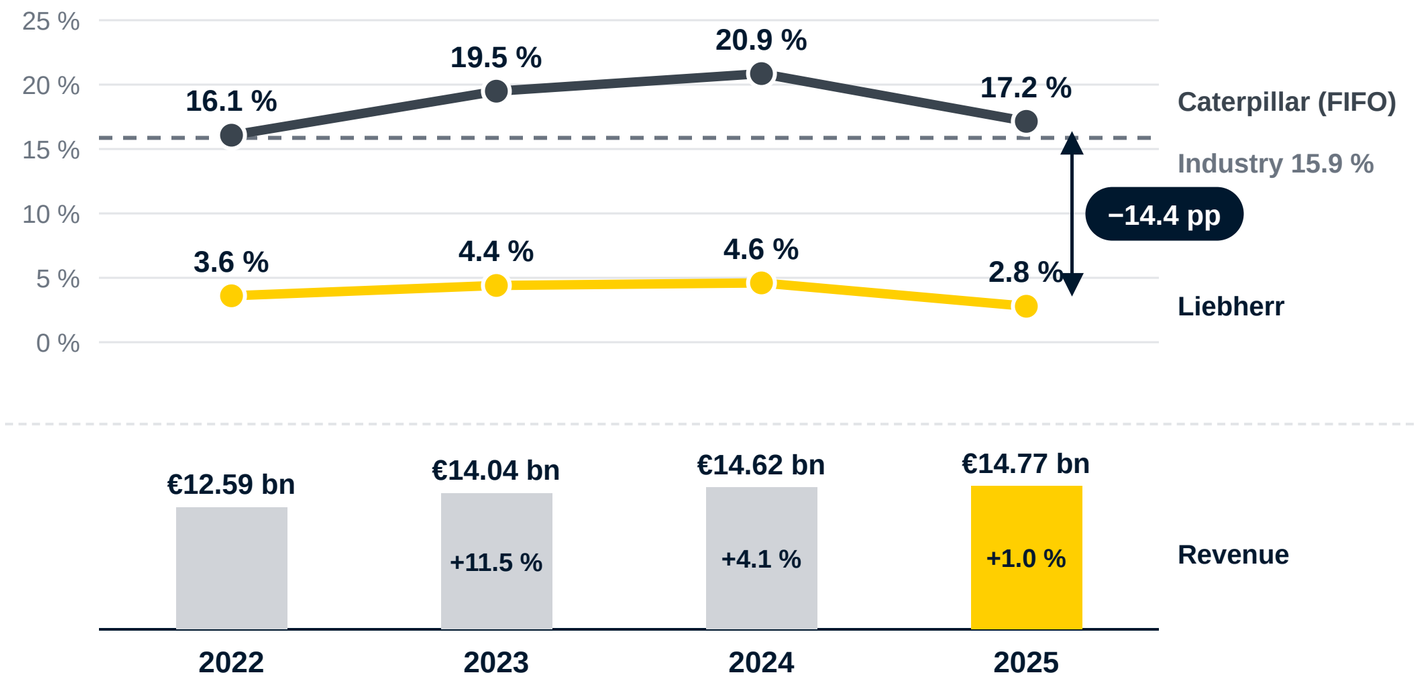
Source: Report §3.2–3.3, Appendix E (VRIO); Liebherr-International AG (2023–2026); Caterpillar Inc. (2026)

FINANCIAL PERFORMANCE

Growth has stalled and the margin fell to 2.8 %

Revenue still grows, but barely – and less of it turns into profit

Operating margin (%) and revenue (€ bn), 2022–2025

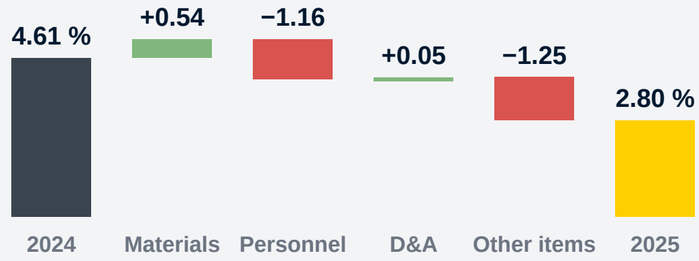


DuPont: why the return on equity fell



pre-tax return on equity · contributions in pp

Margin bridge 2024 → 2025



contribution in percentage points of revenue

INVESTOR LENS **Each percentage point of margin is worth about €148 m of operating profit**

Source: Report §5.2–5.3, Figures 1, 2a and J2; Excel workbook, sheets D4, D6, D10 and Dashboard. Caterpillar on the FIFO basis; industry = Damodaran (2026c), 2025 reference level

ACCOUNTING ANALYSIS

Key figures rest on judgements we cannot verify

Most room for judgement: inventories, provisions and fixed assets – and one cost line without any note

REPORTING LIMIT **Summary statements only (ISA 810) · full audited statements not public · no segment note (IFRS 8 not applicable)**

INVENTORIES · IAS 2

€6,341 m

36.3 % of total assets

- Overhead allocated at a “normal capacity” that is not defined
- Allowance for obsolete stock not disclosed

PROVISIONS · IAS 37

€864 m

of which warranty €530 m

- Gross reversals rose from €90 m (2022) to €143 m (2025)
- But the net charge stayed flat: €195 m → €194 m

PP&E · IAS 16

€4,304 m

25 % of total assets

- Depreciation 5.5 % of cost vs. 6.6 % at Caterpillar
- Own work capitalised €317 m = 77 % of the operating result

DISCLOSURE GAP

+€228 m

other operating expenses 2025 (+11.7 %)

- The largest cost increase of 2025 has no note at all
- 4 of 9 red-flag tests raised a flag

INVESTOR LENS **The 2025 operating result is not a reliable base for extrapolation**

Source: Report §4.1–4.4, Appendix G (Table G2) and Appendix H (Table H1); Excel workbook, sheets C2 and D9

Adjusting for comparability widens the gap

Actual adjustment (Caterpillar) vs. illustrative sensitivities (Liebherr)

ACTUAL ADJUSTMENT · BOOKED IN THE WORKBOOK

Caterpillar: inventories restated LIFO → FIFO

IAS 2 prohibits LIFO and Liebherr does not use it. The disclosed LIFO reserve makes the correction exact, not estimated.

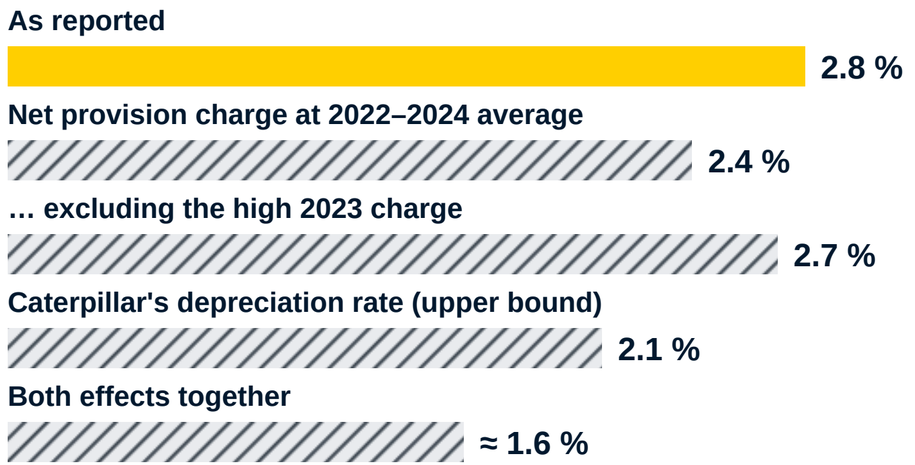
Inventories (LIFO)	+	LIFO reserve	=	FIFO basis
$18,135 m		$4,305 m		$22,440 m

Equity (before tax)	Operating profit 2025	Operating margin
+$4,305 m	+$441 m	16.5 → 17.2 %

Also reclassified: Caterpillar's 2022 goodwill impairment of $925 m as non-recurring. At equal depreciation the gap would be up to **15.1 pp** instead of 14.4 pp.

ILLUSTRATIVE SENSITIVITY · NOT BOOKED

Liebherr operating margin 2025 under the findings



Own work capitalised cannot be measured. The equity ratio would still be **50.4 %** at Caterpillar's depreciation rate – the balance sheet strength holds.

INVESTOR LENS **Accounting does not rescue the case – the reported 2.8 % is, if anything, flattered**

Source: Report §4.4, §6.1, Table J9 and Table H3; Excel workbook, sheets C1 (block A), D9 and D11. Caterpillar figures in USD m, Liebherr in € m – never combined

A strong balance sheet is financing a cash shortfall

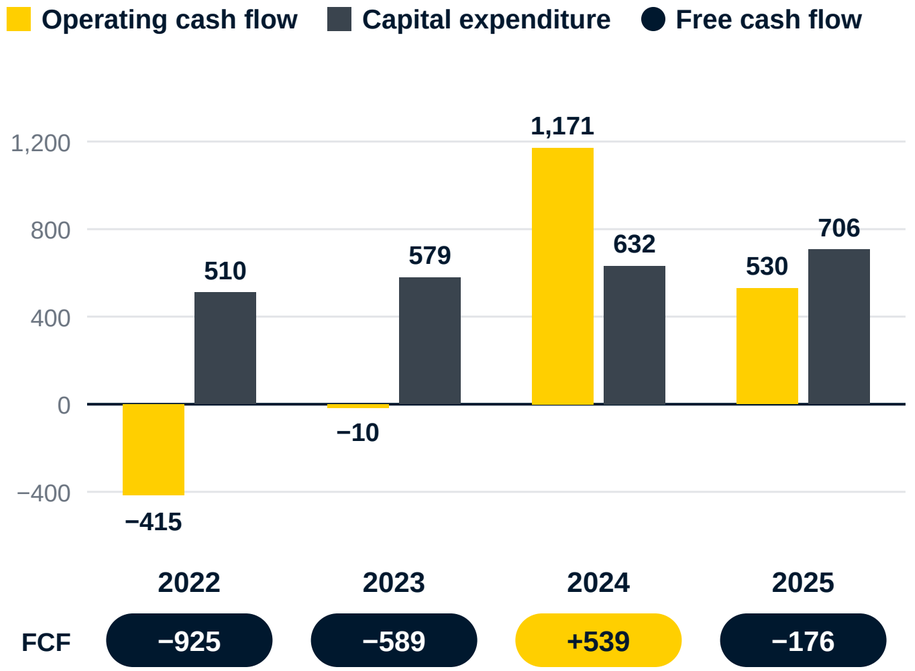
Liquidity and solvency are solid – but investment runs ahead of operating cash flow

53.5 %
Equity ratio 2025
Bank and lease liabilities 23.7 % of capital vs. 39.3 % industry

2.6×
Cash cover of current debt
€3,147 m cash and current financial assets vs. €1,215 m

2.90×
Debt / EBITDA 2025
Up from 2.14 in 2024 – above the industry's 2.30

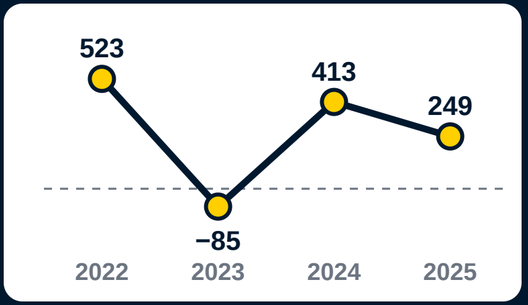
Operating cash flow vs. capital expenditure, € m



2022–2025 CUMULATIVE

Capex **€2,427 m** vs. operating cash flow **€1,276 m** = **190 %**

NET FINANCIAL POSITION, € m



Covers the 2025 shortfall after distributions (€232 m) for only **≈ 1.1 years**.

INVESTOR LENS **Low risk of distress – but the cushion is shrinking**

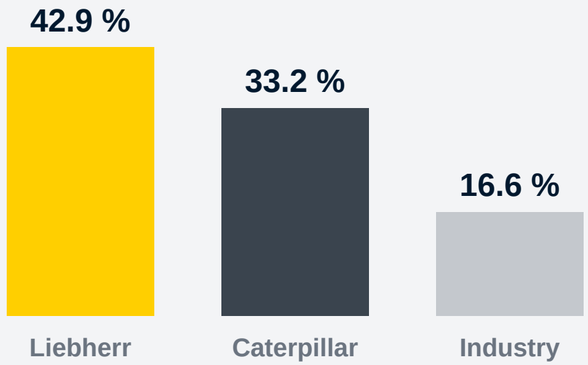
Source: Report §5.5–5.6, Figures 3 and 4, Table 2; Excel workbook, sheets D3, D5, D7 and Dashboard; industry: Damodaran (2026b)

WORKING CAPITAL

Inventories tie up 42.9 % of revenue

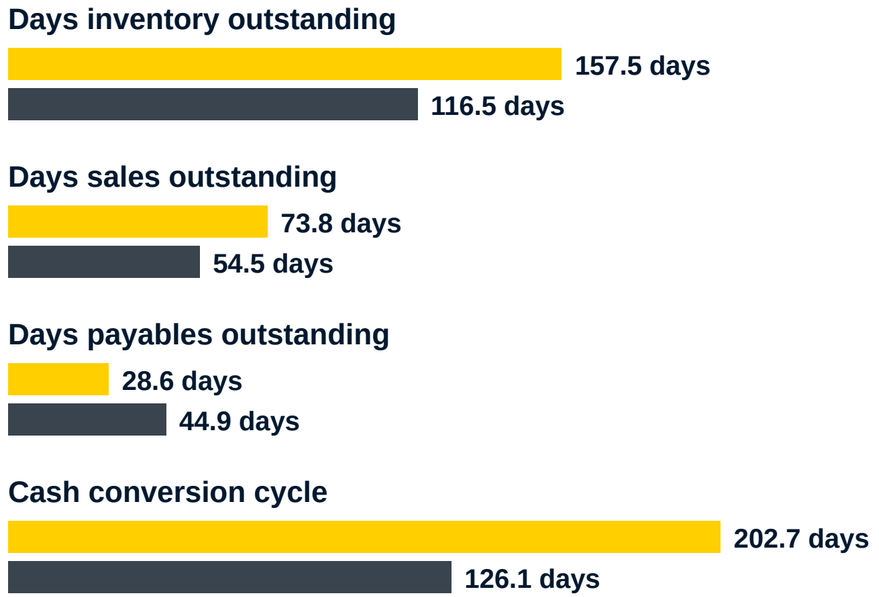
2.6 times the industry average – the cash conversion cycle is a revenue-based proxy

Inventories in % of revenue, 2025



- Causes: in-house production, long order cycles, stock held by own sales companies
- Finished goods alone: €2,490 m

Working-capital days 2025 (revenue basis)



THE LEVER

€405 m

released by a cycle **10 days shorter** (€40.5 m revenue a day)

… but only once. A lasting turnaround needs margin.

INVESTOR LENS **77 days longer cash cycle than Caterpillar – limits Liebherr’s financial flexibility**

Source: Report §5.4, Figure 2b, Table J5; Excel workbook, sheets D3 (block E) and Dashboard; industry: Damodaran (2026e). Days on a revenue basis – a proxy, as Liebherr reports no cost of sales

What would have to change: three conditions for a reassessment

Check them on the 2026 statements – a new assessment only if all three are met. In 2025 none of them is.



1 **Operating margin of at least 3.9 % (four-year average)**

Status 2025 — × 2.8 %

2 **Free cash flow positive and, over time, covering distributions**

Status 2025 — × −€176 m

3 **Information rights: audited statements and other operating expenses**

Status 2025 — × Not secured

REWARD

Resilient, diversified group · back to the 3.9 % average margin = **+€157 m** operating profit at 2025 revenue

RISK AND LIMITS

ROCE 3.5 % (pre-tax) vs. 7.70 % benchmark – needs a margin of ~6–8 % · minority stake: little influence, low payout, hard to sell

Even then: meeting the conditions triggers a new analysis, not a purchase – a minority stake in an unlisted group would only make sense at a discounted price.

Source: Report §5.3, §5.7 and chapter 8, Table 3; Excel workbook, sheets D3, D10 and D11; benchmark: Damodaran (2026a)



CONCLUSION

Financially strong. Operationally challenged.

1 **The balance sheet is strong – and stays strong**

53.5 % equity ratio and 2.6× cash cover; still ≈ 50 % equity ratio in our depreciation sensitivity.

2 **Returns and cash generation are too weak**

2.8 % margin, 12.5–16.2 pp below Caterpillar in every year; free cash flow negative in 3 of 4 years.

3 **The accounting sharpens the verdict**

The measured effects point to a margin of 1.6–2.8 %, and key estimates cannot be verified from outside.

Not yet: the investor should see the turn in the figures before committing capital.



Thank you.

Simon Beermann · Adam Fliegel · Zofia Narkiewicz · Philipp Hoffmann · Zarah Gilmore Islam · HAT1 Financial Reporting · Fontys Venlo

BACKUP

Backup slides for the questions

Not part of the 10-minute talk – click a section to jump there

A **Business model and environment**
DESTEP · Porter's five forces · VRIO and SWOT
Slides 14–16 ▸

B **Accounting analysis**
Red flags · room for judgement · adjustments · reliability of ratios
Slides 17–20 ▸

C **Financial analysis**
Growth and costs · DuPont · liquidity and benchmark · cash flow
Slides 21–24 ▸

D **Recommendation, scenarios and risks**
Why 3.9 % is a trigger · scenarios · risks and drop trigger
Slides 25–27 ▸

E **Likely questions and answers**
Six short answers for the Q&A
Slides 28–29 ▸

HOW TO USE

Each backup slide answers one likely question in depth.

Every slide links back here with ◂ **INDEX**.

All figures come from the report and the Excel workbook.

◂ INDEX

Environment: a modest recovery, but costs rise first

DESTEP scan

Economic

European construction equipment market +4.6 % in 2025, +2 to 2.5 % expected for 2026 – while Liebherr's construction and mining revenue fell 5.5 %.

Political

US tariffs cut Liebherr's North American crane revenue in 2025. Caterpillar expected a tariff impact of $2,600 m in 2026.

Social

Construction had 792 fatal accidents at work in the EU in 2023, 24.0 % of the total. Safety becomes a purchase criterion.

Technological

Autonomous and electrified machines. EU Regulation 2023/1230 covers autonomous functions from 20 January 2027.

Ecological

EU emission limits for non-road machinery and the target of at least 55 % net emission cuts by 2030 make low-emission machines a purchase criterion.

Demographic

Shortages of skilled workers and machine operators push costs up. Personnel expenses reached 28.6 % of revenue in 2025.

Source: Report §3.1.1; CECE (2026), Eurostat (2025), European Union (2023), Liebherr-International AG (2026), Caterpillar Inc. (2026)

◂ INDEX

Competitive forces squeeze the margin

Porter's five forces

New entrants	Moderate, rising	Chinese producers enter with cheaper, simplified machines. Mobile and crawler crane revenue fell 6.8 % in 2025.
Supplier power	Moderate, rising	Cost of materials is 52.7 % of revenue. Electrification shifts power to battery and electronics suppliers.
Buyer power	High, stable	Receivables rose 9.1 % against revenue growth of 1.0 % in 2025. About half of fleet owners may reconsider their brands by 2028.
Substitutes	Low to moderate, rising	Renting and automation change how much equipment is needed. The rental fleet took €305 m, 28.8 % of 2025 investment.
Rivalry	High, rising	The fixed cost of staying in the market rises. The operating margin fell from 4.6 % in 2024 to 2.8 % in 2025.

INVESTOR LENS **Limited industry profit potential – consistent with the fall to 2.8 %**

Source: Report §3.1.2, Table 1; ratings are the judgement of the report

◂ INDEX

Hard-to-copy resources – locked in the asset base

VRIO and SWOT

VRIO: what is hard to copy

- **Sustained advantage:** in-house key technologies (40+ production sites in 16 countries), application engineering (R&D €708 m, 4.8 % of revenue), family ownership with permanent capital (equity ratio 53.5 %)
- **Parity only:** wholly-owned sales and service network, decentralised divisional structure
- **Temporary to sustained:** internal capital market

Strengths

Vertical integration · equity ratio 53.5 % · 13 segments

Weaknesses

Margin 2.8 % vs. 17.2 % at Caterpillar · operating cash flow €1,171 m → €530 m · no segment disclosure

Opportunities

Low-emission and automated machines · European market +4.6 % in 2025

Threats

Low-price competitors from China · US tariffs · transition costs for new drives and autonomy

Source: Report §3.2 and §3.4, Tables E1 and D1

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Red-flag screen: reasons to ask, not proof

Nine tests over four years

Four red flags

- **Provision reversals:** €143 m in 2025, 34.6 % of the operating result if credited within it
- **Receivables vs. revenue:** receivables +9.1 % against revenue +1.0 % in 2025
- **Profit vs. tax:** effective tax rate 99.2 %, 45.1 %, 58.2 % and 37.8 % (2022–2025), no reconciliation
- **Impairment:** €55 m in 2023, six times the level of the other years

Clean or not testable

- **Clean:** no off-balance-sheet arrangements disclosed · same auditor (Ernst & Young), no qualified opinion · no change of policy or estimate
- **Not testable:** related party transactions (no note in four years) · large year-end adjustments (no interim figures)

4
flags raised

3
clean

2
not testable

Source: Report §4.4, Table H1; financial statements 2022–2025

◂ INDEX

Where management has room for judgement

Rated by the judgement the standard allows and the materiality of the amount

HIGH FLEXIBILITY

Highest flexibility

- Inventories: €6,341 m, 36.3 % of total assets, allowance not disclosed
- Provisions: €864 m, of which €530 m warranty
- Impairment test
- Deferred tax assets: €285 m

MEDIUM FLEXIBILITY

Also material

- Own work capitalised: €317 m, 77 % of the operating result
- PP&E: €4,304 m, machinery written off over 5 to 21 years
- Revenue timing: advance payments €896 m, contract liabilities €289 m

LOW FLEXIBILITY

Lowest flexibility

- Borrowing costs
- Lessee accounting
- Translation of foreign currency
- The standard prescribes the mechanics – little choice for management

Source: Report §4.2–4.3, Table G2 (30 treatments, nine of them key)

◂ INDEX

22 findings: what we could adjust and what we could not

Short list of the accounting analysis

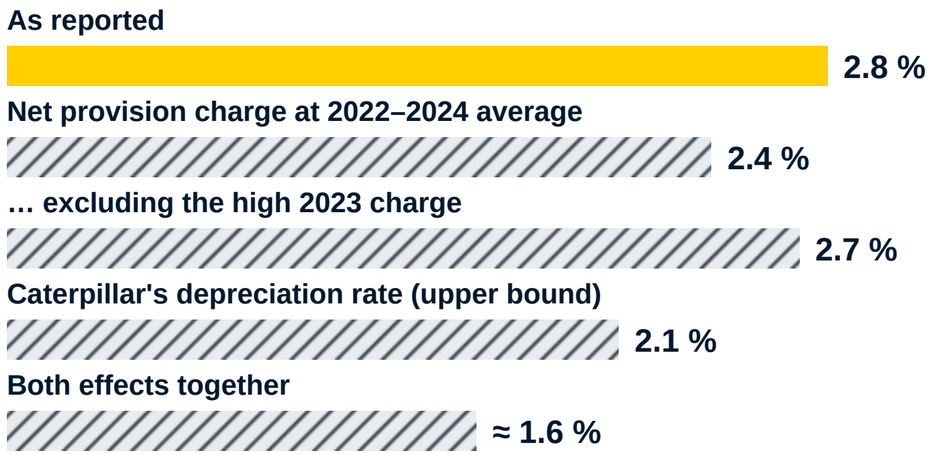
7 **not adjustable**
Red flags and disclosure gaps, e.g. provision reversals of €143 m, missing related party note

5 **reversed in the workbook**
e.g. Caterpillar LIFO → FIFO: equity +$4,305 m, operating profit +$441 m; goodwill impairment 2022

10 **not reversible**
Disclosure too thin, e.g. undefined normal capacity, own work capitalised €317 m

ILLUSTRATIVE SENSITIVITY · NOT BOOKED

Liebherr operating margin 2025



The quantified effects point to a weaker result – the weakness is, if anything, understated.

Source: Report chapter 4, Tables H2, H3 and J13; Excel workbook, sheets C1 and D9

◂ INDEX

How far the key ratios can be trusted

After the accounting analysis the ratios fall into three groups

Reliable

- Operating margin trend
- Inventory and payable days
- Current ratio 2.31, quick ratio 1.16
- Cash conversion 53.0 % and free cash flow −€176 m

Usable with bias

- Margin level 2.8 % – scenarios 1.6 % to 2.8 %
- Days sales outstanding 73.8
- Equity ratio 53.5 % (50.4 % at Caterpillar's depreciation rate)
- Fixed asset turnover 3.49

Not usable

- Net margin 1.8 % and return on equity 3.0 % – tax rate 37.8 % to 99.2 %
- Interest cover
- Comparisons with Caterpillar built on equity

Source: Report §6.3, Table J13; 2025 figures; Excel workbook, sheets D3 and D9

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Growth and cost structure 2022–2025

Operating margin per year, with revenue and operating profit

2022	2023	2024	2025
3.6 %	**4.4 %**	**4.6 %**	**2.8 %**
Revenue €12,589 m	Revenue €14,042 m	Revenue €14,622 m	Revenue €14,772 m
Operating profit €454 m	Operating profit €619 m	Operating profit €674 m	Operating profit €413 m

Where growth stalled

- Revenue growth 11.5 % (2023) → 4.1 % (2024) → 1.0 % (2025)
- Construction and mining −5.5 % to €9,345 m
- Other segments +14.7 % to €5,427 m, components +35.5 %

Where the margin went

- Personnel expense +5.3 % to €4,226 m vs. revenue +1.0 %
- Personnel share of revenue 26.4 % (2023) → 28.6 % (2025)
- Other operating items cost another 1.25 pp
- Each margin point = €148 m operating profit

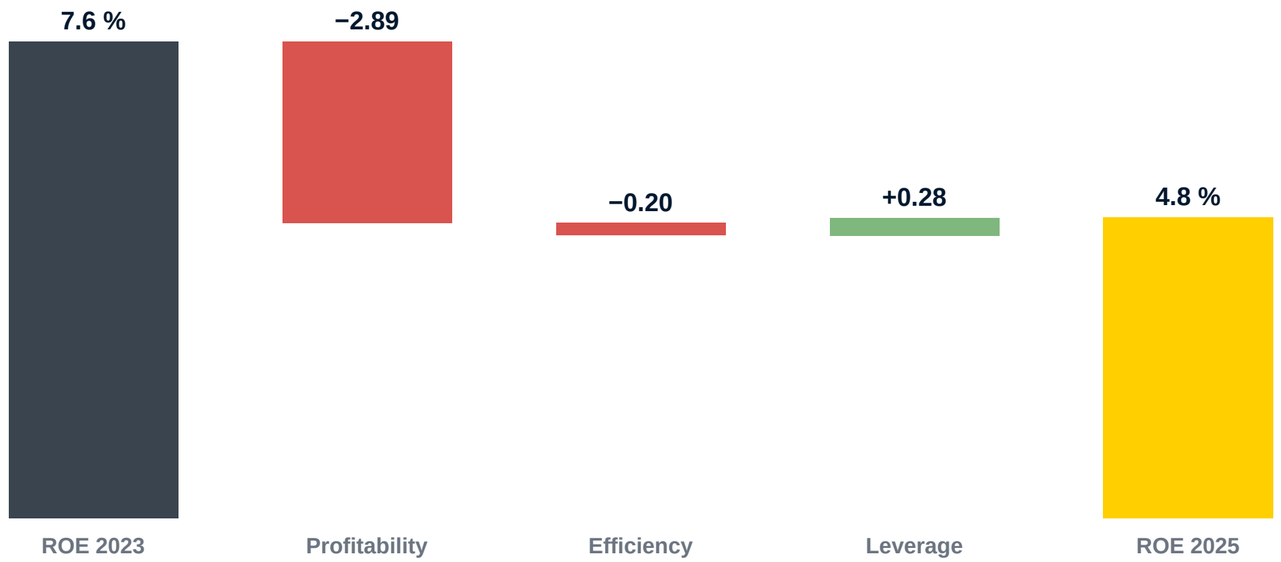
Source: Report §5.2; Excel workbook, sheets D1 and D6

◂ INDEX

DuPont: the margin, not leverage, drives returns down

Pre-tax return on equity 2023 → 2025

Contributions to the change in pre-tax ROE, percentage points



pre-tax return on equity · contributions in pp

What it means

- **Profitability −2.89 pp:** lower pre-tax margin
- **Efficiency −0.20 pp:** slightly lower asset turnover
- **Leverage +0.28 pp:** more debt even helped a little
- After tax, ROE was 3.0 % vs. 16.4 % in the US industry – but the tax charge is volatile, so the trend is read before tax

Source: Report §5.3, Figure 2a, Table J4; Excel workbook, sheets D4 and D6 (logarithmic split)

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Strong solvency, far weaker returns

Liquidity, solvency and benchmark 2025

Balance sheet strength

- Equity ratio 53.5 %; bank and lease liabilities 23.7 % of capital (industry 39.3 %)
- Cash and current financial assets €3,147 m cover current debt of €1,215 m 2.6×
- Current ratio 2.31 vs. 1.55 at Caterpillar
- Net financial position €523 m (2022) → net debt €85 m (2023) → €249 m (2025)
- Debt / EBITDA 2.14 → 2.90; interest cover 11.07 (2022) → 3.90 (2025)

2025	LIEBHERR	US INDUSTRY	CATERPILLAR
Operating margin	**2.8 %**	15.9 %	17.2 %
EBITDA margin	**6.8 %**	19.6 %	19.8 %
Return on equity	**3.0 %**	16.4 %	38.1 %*
Inventories, % of revenue	**42.9 %**	16.6 %	33.2 %
Debt / EBITDA	**2.90**	2.30	3.52

* Not comparable – Caterpillar's equity is reduced by treasury shares. Caterpillar on the FIFO basis.

Source: Report §5.1 and §5.5, Table J14; Damodaran (2026), US machinery industry, January 2026; Excel workbook, sheets D3, D7 and D10

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Liebherr invests ahead of its cash

Cash flow and capital allocation

190.2 %
Capex in % of operating cash flow, 2022–2025

–€1,151 m
Free cash flow in total, 2022–2025

28.4 %
of EBITDA became operating cash flow, 2022–2025 (53.0 % in 2025)

€530 m
Operating cash flow 2025, down from €1,171 m (2024)

Liebherr invests ahead of its cash

- Capex and R&D 9.6 % of revenue vs. 7.4 % at Caterpillar – at a margin of 2.8 % vs. 17.2 %
- Shortfall after distributions €388 m (2023–2025)
- Bank and lease liabilities +€562 m (2022–2025)

Caterpillar returns cash

- Free cash flow $7,453 m in 2025, 11.0 % of revenue
- 73.1 % of operating cash flow returned to shareholders (2022–2025)
- Liebherr distributed €56 m in 2025 – little current income for an investor

Source: Report §5.6, Figure 4; Excel workbook, sheets D5, D7 and D10

◂ INDEX

Why 3.9 % is only a trigger, not a target

Condition 1 of the reassessment

3.9 %
Average operating margin 2022–2025 (3.86 %)

+€157 m
Operating profit at 2025 revenue (€14,772 m)

3.5 %
ROCE before tax 2025 vs. 7.70 % after-tax benchmark

6–8 %
Operating margin needed to earn the benchmark

What the trigger means

- A return to 3.9 % is the first realistic sign of recovery – Liebherr has earned it on average
- It is a test, not a target return
- Each margin point is worth €148 m

Why it is not enough

- Even in 2024, at a 4.6 % margin, ROCE was only 5.9 % before tax – below the 7.70 % benchmark
- The benchmark is the US machinery industry, not Liebherr's own cost of capital
- A margin recovery alone does not prove an adequate return

Source: Report §5.3 and §5.7, chapter 8; Excel workbook, sheets D3 and D10; Damodaran (2026a)

◂ INDEX

What the scenarios are worth

Operating profit at 2025 revenue (€14,772 m) – illustrations, not forecasts

Margin scenarios

2025 actual · 2.80 % margin



€413 m

Four-year average · 3.86 % margin



€570 m **+€157 m**

Best year 2024 · 4.61 % margin



€681 m **+€268 m**

US industry average · 15.86 % margin

€2,343 m **+€1,930 m**

The industry figure shows the size of the gap and is not a target.

Cash scenarios (2025)

- Free cash flow −€176 m: the net financial position of €249 m covers it 1.4 years
- After distributions (−€232 m): 1.1 years
- Capex at the level of depreciation (€587 m): +€119 m, free cash flow still −€57 m
- Cash conversion cycle 10 days shorter: €405 m released once

Source: Report Table J15; Excel workbook, sheet D10. Margins Liebherr has earned or the industry average – nothing is assumed

◂ INDEX

Risks, limits and when to drop the case

What could still go wrong – and the alternative for a cautious investor

Demand

Construction and mining revenue −5.5 % in 2025; no significant upswing expected before 2027

Costs

US tariffs and the cost of autonomous and electrified machines press on the margin

Information

The largest cost increase of 2025 cannot be explained from the summary statements

Valuation

Not assessed in the report – price and contract rights decide the case

Alternative for a risk-averse investor

Equity is unsuitable: low payout, shares not traded. A loan may fit better, as equity of 53.5 % limits the default risk – but pricing, maturity, collateral and covenants are not disclosed.

Drop trigger

If the margin stays near 2.8 % in 2026 **and** the net financial position turns negative, the investor should drop the case rather than wait for 2027. A recovery should not rest on large provision releases.

Source: Report §5.5, §5.7, §6.1 and chapter 8

Why not invest now?

Likely questions (1/2)

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Q Why not invest now?

Neither financial condition was met in 2025: the margin of 2.8 % is below its four-year average of 3.9 %, and free cash flow was −€176 m. The answer is **not yet**, rather than no.

Q Why is 3.9 % the first test?

It is the average Liebherr earned from 2022 to 2025 – a realistic first sign of recovery. At 2025 revenue it adds €157 m of operating profit. A trigger, not a target return.

Q Is the LIFO to FIFO adjustment fair?

IAS 2 does not permit LIFO, so FIFO puts both groups on one basis. Caterpillar's LIFO reserve of $4,305 m lifts its margin only from 16.50 % to 17.15 % – the gap stays large.

Source: Report chapters 4 to 8; Excel workbook, sheets C1, D3 and D10

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What the balance sheet cannot fix

Likely questions (2/2)

Q What do the red flags mean?

They are reasons to ask, not proof of manipulation. Four flags are raised, three tests are clean and two cannot be run on the published statements – that is why information rights come first.

Q Why is ROCE so low?

ROCE is 3.5 % before tax against a 7.70 % after-tax benchmark: the margin is only 2.8 %, and inventories of 42.9 % of revenue and a cash cycle 77 days longer than Caterpillar's tie up capital.

Q Why is a strong balance sheet not a return?

An equity ratio of 53.5 % and a net financial position of €249 m limit the risk, but do not earn the cost of capital. They would cover a shortfall like 2025 (−€232 m) for about 1.1 years.

Source: Report chapters 4 to 8; Excel workbook, sheets C1, D3 and D10